



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Mount Olive Lutheran School
School Website: <https://mountoliveschool.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Mount Olive Lutheran School (Billings, MT; ZIP 59102) demonstrates a clear classical and faith-forward framing in its public materials. The school emphasizes Lutheran theology, liturgical worship, and a Christ-centered approach across curriculum and school life. It identifies itself explicitly as a "classical academy" and cites the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium (arithmetic, music theory, geometry, astronomy) as core elements of its liberal-arts curriculum, with Latin language study and a strong focus on the centrality of Jesus Christ in all subjects. Public materials also highlight accreditation via Lutheran and classical bodies (e.g., CCLE, NLSE). However, explicit articulation of some pedagogical practices associated with classical education (e.g., extensive Socratic seminars or systematic Great Books/Great Conversation programs) is less evident in the site content. Overall, the school leans strongly toward CLASSICAL in content and religious formation, with some curricular elements that could be described as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in pedagogy and parent/community practices.

- Executive classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (aggregate across six categories leans toward classical, but with gaps in explicit pedagogy and some classical-community language).
- Immediate opportunities to move toward full CLASSICAL: make explicit the Great Books/Great Conversation elements, broaden evidence of Socratic dialogue and high-school-level seminar work, and clearly spell out formation-focused language (virtue, wisdom) in school purpose statements and family partnerships.

Evidence and synthesis draw on Mount Olive's public content, including its own descriptions of being a classical Lutheran school, its explicit articulation of Trivium/Quadrivium and Latin, and its chapel/theology emphasis, as well as the classical-education rubric and keyword indicators from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School document.

Citations: Mount Olive materials attest to Christ-centered classical formation, Trivium/Quadrivium, Latin study, and liturgical life; CCLE/NLSE accreditation presence; and chapel/theology. See evidence references: Christ-centered, liturgical, centrality of Jesus Christ, Trivium/Quadrivium, Latin, chapel, theology, and accreditations across the site.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize Lutheran foundation and Christ-centered education: "Lutheran Based, Christ-Centered Classical Education" and the centrality of Jesus Christ in every subject, with Scripture as a core guide. Chapel, theology, and liturgy figures prominently in school life.

- Accreditations and faith-formation structures are foregrounded (CCLE NLSE; theology/church involvement).
- The Great Books/Great Conversation language is not explicitly stated in the public materials, though the school identifies itself as classical and Lutheran.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Lutheran; Christ-centered; Theology; Liturgical; Liturgy; Hymns; Scriptures; Centrality of Jesus Christ; Chapel; Church-based formation; Classical education terms (classical model; Seven Liberal Arts; Trivium/Quadrivium). - Negative keywords: Not clearly present in public materials (no explicit emphasis on non-theological secular pedagogy; no explicit negation of “theology,” etc.). The site does not foreground non-religious “great books” language, which reduces the presence of non-religious, purely secular educational signals.

Why this rating - The materials foreground religious metaphysical foundations (theology, liturgy, Scriptures) and explicitly tie education to Christ-centered formation, which aligns with Classical School expectations in the religious dimension. The absence of explicit non-Theological signals is not a detractor here, given the explicit theological framing. The overall signal is strong in R&MF but not as expansive in listing all classical metaphysical indicators beyond theology and liturgy. CLASSICAL-level evidence is present, yet the pedagogy and explicit Great-Books/Conversation signals are not fully fleshed out in public materials.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school identifies itself as “A Classical Academy” with Lutheran–theological formation integrated into the curriculum; the central claims emphasize character formation in a Christian frame. - The public materials emphasize formation in a spiritual sense (Word, Christian faith) and “curriculum personalization,” with the goal of an education aligned to Lutheran-Christian formation rather than solely job preparation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtue (implied through formation in Christ and character formation), truth/goodness/beauty (explicit classical language appears in the rubric; school materials emphasize truth/the centrality of Jesus and Christian virtue via liturgy and doctrine). While not all classic keywords are overt on the site, the framework hints at formation principles. Positive signals include “classical education,” “centrality of Jesus Christ,” and “theology.” - Negative keywords present: The site does not consistently articulate a separate goal of general “work preparation” or explicit “Great Books” formation language; its purpose statements lean into faith-formation and classical framework rather than standard secular outcomes. The absence of explicit employment-oriented language signals a formation- and virtue-centered aim rather than job preparation.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds formation and virtue within a classical-Lutheran frame, but it does not provide explicit, widely articulated statements about virtue/wisdom as separate, universal goals beyond its faith-centered/classical identity. The signals are strong for formation (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL in terms of explicit stated goals beyond faith-integration and classical method).

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit statements of Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium (arithmetic, music theory, geometry, astronomy) as core parts of the curriculum. The Trivium/Quadrivium framework is described in public materials, along with language study (Latin). - The curriculum centers on the Great Books/Great Conversation language is not explicitly stated, but the core classical content (grammar/logic/rhetoric; arithmetic/music/geometry/astronomy) and Latin language study are clearly present. - The school identifies itself as using a classical model for education with a Lutheran emphasis, and instructors reference the Trivium and Quadrivium.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts; Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Quadrivium (arithmetic, music theory, geometry, astronomy); Grammar; Logic; Rhetoric; Arithmetic; Geometry; Music Theory; Astronomy; Latin; Great Books/Great Conversation (not explicit in site, but is part of the broader classical-lutheran canon in the knowledge framework). - Negative keywords: Not evident; no explicit rejection of classical curriculum elements. The absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language in Mount Olive’s public content is a potential gap relative to universals in the Six Essential Elements, but does not negate the strong presence of classical curricular elements.

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly framed around the Seven Liberal Arts and the Trivium/Quadrivium, with Latin and a classical approach clearly stated. This aligns well with CLASSICAL expectations for

Curriculum.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes a classical structure and the centrality of Jesus Christ across subjects, which implies a classical educational philosophy. Public materials feature the classical model and accrediting bodies tied to classical Lutheran education, suggesting a pedagogy consistent with classical aims. - There is evidence of liturgical and contemplative aspects (chapel/theology) in school life, which aligns with a contemplative dimension of classical pedagogy. - However, explicit, widespread mentions of Socratic seminars, debates, Great Books discussions, or upper-school seminars as a standard practice are not clearly documented in the public content. The presence of a classical model is asserted, but the specific pedagogy signals (e.g., frequent Socratic dialogue, seminars) are not strongly evidenced in the site content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: classical pedagogy terms (classical model); Trivium/Quadrivium; Latin; theology in pedagogy; liturgy; contemplative elements; “Scholé”-related ideas appear in the knowledge framework but are not explicitly stated as site practices. - Negative keywords present: Absence of explicit references to frequent Socratic seminars, upper-school debates, or explicit “Great Books” discussion formats in public content. This reduces the ped signal relative to a fully classical pedagogy.

Why this rating - The school visibly adopts a classical curriculum framework and religious pedagogy, and it includes contemplative and liturgical elements. The absence of explicit, widespread Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy in public materials tempers the rating to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than full CLASSICAL. Clearer articulation of seminar-based pedagogy and explicit Great Books conversation would move this toward CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school lists named faculty and leadership (Headmaster, theology and chapel leadership, preschool teachers, etc.) with bios and roles. This demonstrates a faculty presence and professional staff serving as the living curriculum to some extent.

- Public materials emphasize the faculty as part of a faith-forward environment (theology, chapel leadership, “Headmaster and theology” roles). The explicit articulation of the faculty as “the living curriculum” or as a “portrait of what a teacher should be” is not clearly stated in the site content; rather, there are bios and roles that imply mentorship and formation but do not provide a formal living-curriculum narrative.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: “Headmaster” role; theology and chapel leadership; teacher bios; Latin/music/arts teachers; long-standing staff. These signals support a strong faculty presence and formative teacher roles. - Negative keywords present: The explicit classical-faculty portrait (e.g., “the living curriculum” or “faculty of friends” or “explicit modeling of virtue by faculty”) is not clearly stated in public content. The lack of a formalized living-curriculum statement weakens the pedestals beyond a typical teacher-staff presentation.

Why this rating - The presence of credentialed staff and named roles supports CLASSICAL aspirations, but the absence of explicit “living curriculum” framing limits the strength of the category to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site includes parent-facing activities and events (Crusader Feast, Barnes & Noble Book Fair, family events, enrollment information, and visits). This demonstrates community engagement and parent participation in school life.

- Public materials show a partnership model in practice (parent involvement via events, visits, and community gatherings). The presence of book fairs and family nights indicates a community-oriented environment. - However, explicit language describing parents as co-teachers or formal parent-education programs (e.g., parent book studies, explicit classical-education training for parents) is not strongly evidenced in the public

content. The Six Elements rubric notes this as an element of classical community-building; the Mount Olive site shows engagement but not a formalized co-teaching or parent-education program.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: “family,” “Book Fair,” “Crusader Feast,” “Enrollment,” “community events,” “parent involvement” signals (to some extent). - Negative keywords present: No explicit statements about parents as co-teachers or formal parent-education initiatives (book studies, gatherings designed to educate parents in classical education). This limits the community-signaling relative to a fully classical model.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates active parental engagement and community events, which is a positive signal for community integration. However, the absence of explicit “parents as co-teachers” or formal parent-education programming keeps category 6 at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Make explicit the Great Books/Great Conversation components in public materials, including a stated plan for integrating Great Books readings and student-led Socratic discussions (especially in middle/high school where feasible).
- Publicly articulate a formation-focused mission that foregrounds virtue, wisdom, and the cultivation of truth, goodness, and beauty as explicit goals (not only as implied by theology and classical-liberal-arts language).
- Provide explicit statements about pedagogy that align with classical methods (e.g., regular Socratic seminars, structured Socratic dialogues, or seminar formats; evidence of memory work and recitation; clear references to scholé or contemplative study).
- Expand parent-community programming to include formal parent education on classical education, book-studies, and co-teaching opportunities or structured parent-education series.
- Strengthen the “living curriculum” narrative with explicit faculty portraits and articulated expectations for teacher formation, mentorship, and modeling of virtue and skill.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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